

English Ladder

Teaching Guide

Understanding Events & Tenses in English

A concise classroom guide with lesson flow, teaching cues, and a ready-to-use answer key built around the same English Ladder concept sheet.



Grammar Concepts #14

Key Points

Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **Understanding Events & Tenses in English** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

ENGLISH LADDER

Concept #14 ► **Events & Tenses**

Here are a few examples of ways to talk about two events from different temporal (time) perspectives.

2018



Martin marries

2015



Martin graduates

2013



Martin graduates

2010



Martin marries

2008



Martin graduates

Martin graduated 5 years prior to marrying.

Martin married 5 years after he graduated.

Martin married 3 years ago and graduated 8 years ago.

Martin will marry 5 years after his graduation.

Martin graduated 5 years before he plans to marry.

Martin graduated 3 years ago. He'll marry 2 years from now.

It has been 3 years since Martin's graduation.

Two years from now, Martin will marry.

Martin will graduate 5 years before he marries.

Martin will marry 5 years after he graduates.

Martin will graduate in 2 years and marry 7 years from now.

Remember that if the reference point is now, we use **ago** and **from now/in**. For other times we use **before/prior to** and **after**.

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At a Glance

Lesson focus Understanding Events & Tenses in English	Suggested timing 45-60 minutes
Core objective Students explain the target pattern clearly and apply it accurately in controlled practice and discussion.	Materials Student PDF, the concept image, board space, and time for partner checking.

Suggested Lesson Flow

Warm-up	Display the concept image and ask learners to predict the rule behind Understanding Events & Tenses in English before reading the explanation.
Model	Walk through the Core Idea and the sections on Key Points. Pause after each part so students can restate the pattern in plain English.
Guided practice	Project two or three examples from the concept sheet and ask pairs to explain why each choice works, not just what the answer is.
Independent work	Assign the 24 practice items for quiet work, partner checking, and final feedback.
Closure	Ask students to create one new sentence or mini-example of their own that follows the same pattern.



Likely Learner Errors

- Learners may overgeneralize the first pattern they notice. Keep returning to **Key Points** and ask students to explain what changes from one example to the next.
- Long explanations can hide the signal word or structure. Have students underline the exact phrase that tells them which form, pattern, or response is needed.
- If students can choose an answer but cannot explain it, ask them to justify their choice using words taken directly from the concept sheet.

Differentiation and Delivery Notes

- Support: teach one section at a time, then send students back to **the examples** or the practice set so they can apply the same rule immediately.
- Pair work: let students compare answers aloud before you reveal the key. The explanation step is as important as the final answer.
- Extension: ask stronger students to write two fresh examples or a short dialogue that uses the same target language accurately.

Model Language from the Concept Sheet

- Maria learned Spanish 3 years prior to moving to Spain.
- Alex started his business 2 years after finishing college.
- Julia visited Paris 2 years ago and graduated from university 5 years ago.
- Sarah will travel to Japan 1 year after she gets her passport.
- David bought a house 2 years before he plans to retire.
- Emily started her job 4 years ago. She plans to start her own business 3 years from now.



Answer Key

Use this key for whole-class feedback or fast marking.

ITEM 01

Maria learned Spanish 3 years prior to moving to Spain.

ITEM 02

Alex started his business 2 years after finishing college.

ITEM 03

Julia visited Paris 2 years ago and graduated from university 5 years ago.

ITEM 04

Sarah will travel to Japan 1 year after she gets her passport.

ITEM 05

David bought a house 2 years before he plans to retire.

ITEM 06

Emily started her job 4 years ago. She plans to start her own business 3 years from now.

ITEM 07

It has been 6 months since Anna moved to New York.

ITEM 08

Two weeks from now, I will start my new job.

ITEM 09

Lucy will finish her book 2 years before it gets published.

ITEM 10

John will travel to Europe 1 year after he completes his degree.

ITEM 11

Lisa will finish her training in 6 months and start her own practice 1 year from now.

ITEM 12

Martin will marry 5 years after his graduation.

ITEM 13

Martin graduated 5 years before he plans to marry.

ITEM 14

Martin graduated 3 years ago. He'll marry 2 years from now.



ITEM 15

It has been 3 years since Martin's graduation.

ITEM 16

Two years from now, Martin will marry.

ITEM 17

Martin will graduate 5 years before he marries.

ITEM 18

Martin will marry 5 years after he graduates.

ITEM 19

Martin will graduate in 2 years and marry 7 years from now.

ITEM 20

John graduated 3 years ago, and he will start his master's degree 2 years from now.

ITEM 21

Alice will complete her project 6 months from now and present it 3 months after she finishes.

ITEM 22

It has been 2 years since he last visited his hometown.

ITEM 23

Tom will graduate in 1 year and start his job 2 years from now.

ITEM 24

It has been 4 years since I moved to this city.



Feedback Cues

- Item 01: Explanation: "Prior to" means before a certain time or event. "Ago" is incorrect because it is used with a specific point in time in the past, not before another event. "Since" is incorrect because it is used to indicate the time from a past event to the present.
- Item 02: Explanation: "After" is used to indicate that one event happened following another. "Ago" is incorrect because it is used to specify how long before the present something happened. "Before" is incorrect because it would suggest the business was started before finishing college, which changes the meaning.
- Item 03: Explanation: "Ago" is used to indicate a time period that has passed from the present moment. "Before" and "after" are incorrect because they compare two events relative to each other, not relative to the present moment.
- Item 04: Explanation: "After" is correct to show that Sarah's travel happens following the event of getting her passport. "Ago" is incorrect because it refers to past time. "Before" is incorrect because it would mean she travels before getting her passport.
- Item 05: Explanation: "Before" indicates that the house purchase happened prior to his retirement. "After" is incorrect because it would mean he bought the house following his retirement. "Since" is incorrect because it refers to time passed since a past event.
- Item 06: Explanation: "Ago" indicates past time, while "from now" indicates future time from the present moment. "Before" and "after" do not fit because they do not indicate past or future relative to now.